



Global Performance Management Policy

Scope

This Policy applies to all Directors, Officers, and employees of all Cognizant entities, subsidiaries, and joint ventures over which Cognizant has operational control (collectively “Associates”). Processes and timelines may differ for Associates of acquisitions prior to integration.

This policy does not apply to individuals hired by Cognizant as contractors or through third-party vendors.

Guiding principles

At Cognizant, we are committed to driving and sustaining a culture of high performance. As an organization, we recognize innovation and potential, reward performance, and endeavor to create an environment that allows our associates to perform their best and deliver exceptional value to our clients every day.

This policy outlines our Performance Management principles, which reinforce our commitment to drive high performance and set clearly defined expectations. To that end, this policy sets out the responsibilities for both associates and managers. The overall aim of this policy is to underscore the direct and significant link between the associate's contributions and Cognizant's strategic goal achievements.

We foster a high performing culture by rewarding and promoting people based on their merit, performance and results for the company. We have fundamental principles that drive our performance management process:

- We never discriminate against a person's Legally Protected Characteristics when we make employment decisions, including performance management.
- We optimize the performance of our Associates and the company by aligning individual goals with the strategic priorities of the company.
- We expect our managers and Associates to play an active role in the performance management process.
- We measure success based on our Associates' efforts, skills, abilities, and outcomes/performance.
- We reward demonstrated, sustained high performance.
- We promptly address underperformance and unsatisfactory performance.

Translations

[French \(Canada\)](#)

Key Definitions

Legally Protected Characteristics: Specific aspects, characteristics or any other status protected by applicable national or local law.

Performance Year (PY): Time period set by the company in which performance is reviewed and measured, with the process resetting at the start of each performance year.

Home Manager: The individual who the associate reports to directly in the company (formerly referred to as HCM Manager) and has responsibilities outlined in the Home Manager and Business Manager section of this policy.

Business Manager: The individual who the associate reports to for direction related to the day-to-day deliverables for a particular project or account and has responsibilities outlined in the Home Manager and Business Manager section of this policy.

Related Policies & Processes

- [Go Perform](#)
- [Leadership Performance Management](#)
- [Business Manager Role](#)
- [Code of Ethics](#)
- [Global Workplace Misconduct & Remediation policy](#)
- [Ethics & Compliance Training Policy](#)

Performance Management is a continuous process. It starts with goal setting and includes a constant loop of feedback and learning and development opportunities.

Defining clear goals to set direction. Goals provide a clear structure to Associates and help them align their individual goals to the organizational goals. To be successful, Associates must understand their job responsibilities and have well-defined and measurable goals. After collaborating with their Home and Business Managers to set goals, the Associate must document them in the performance management system.

Associates have individual goals they set with their Home and Business Managers as well as pre-defined goals in the performance management system based on the role and standard organizational and enterprise goals that are applicable to all Associates.

Goals are set during specific times during the performance year – when an Associate first joins Cognizant, at the beginning of the performance year, at scheduled intervals, and when an Associate begins a new role or assignment.

Self-assessment to reflect on goal progress. Associates have the opportunity to reflect on, record, and present their contributions and progress toward established goals to their Home Manager and Business Manager on an ongoing basis.

Timely and actionable feedback is critical. Regular, timely conversations between Associates and their Home and Business Managers serve two purposes. They allow Associates to understand what they are doing well and areas for improvement and they enable two-way discussions concerning the Associate's career aspirations. These conversations should happen as often as they are needed, with the Associate feeling empowered to initiate them. There are also specific times when Associates will receive feedback – at the end of training or an introductory period, during company scheduled check-ins, at project roll-off, and at the end of each performance year.

Closing out the performance year. A year-end performance conversation reviews the Associate's results for the performance year against role expectations, defined goals, and their contributions to the team and Cognizant's organizational goals.

Associates who join the company on or before the established cut-off date for the performance year will receive a rating. The Home Manager assigns an initial rating for each Associate based on a scale defined and communicated by the company. Initial ratings are then aligned across each level, team, and business group to ensure the same standards are applied to measure performance and outcomes. The final performance rating is communicated to the Associate.

Rewarding performance. Rewarding behaviors aligned to our future enables us to recognize results (the "what") while being good stewards of our organization (the "how"). Performance-based compensation and promotions are vital tools Cognizant utilizes to reward demonstrated, sustained high performance, in accordance with local laws and regulations. Associates should refer to their employment contract or offer letter for any specific terms.

Introductory period to measure fit. Associates may have an introductory or probationary period when they join Cognizant. Performance assessments for these periods are governed by the terms outlined in each Associate's employment contract, offer letter or pursuant to the practices of the project or account. These periods are not required by the company in all countries and/or across all career levels and may be subject to local laws and regulations.

Performance improvement plans for sustained improvement. A performance improvement plan (PIP) is a formal tool used when an Associate falls short of meeting their goals and expectations, cannot sustain the expected level of performance, or has received an unsatisfactory performance rating. The PIP document identifies the Associate's performance

issues, sets achievable goals for success during an established timeframe, and identifies tools and resources available to support that success. PIPs are utilized and implemented at Cognizant's discretion. PIPs are developed and delivered to the Associate by Home Managers and/or Business Managers in discussion with Talent Partner/Talent Managers/HR Business Partners, as applicable, in accordance with local laws and regulations. Failure to show improvement in performance for the duration defined in the PIP, or failure to sustain improvement after successful completion of the PIP, may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment in accordance with local law.

Impact of disciplinary action. Our [Code of Ethics](#) encompasses the standards and [values](#) that all Cognizant's Associates are expected to follow. Where allowable by applicable law and local regulation, any Company-issued disciplinary action may result in impact to performance review/rating; impact to bonus or variable performance pay; and/or consideration in promotion decisions. Please refer to the [Global Workplace Misconduct and Remediation Policy](#).

Using Cognizant communication channels. Cognizant communicates all information about the annual performance cycle to our Associates through [Be.Cognizant](#) and Cognizant email. All Home Managers, Business Managers and Associates must understand the performance management process, adhere to cycle timelines, and complete any required training. Associates must regularly check their Cognizant email and not use client email and systems when communicating internal Cognizant employment-related matters.

Disputing outcomes. Associates with concerns around the objectivity of the process or who believe that the procedures or policies were not followed appropriately during any part of the Performance Management process can raise their concern or complaint through their Talent Partner/Talent Manager/HR Business Partner. The outcome of any such process will be at the company's sole discretion, and in accordance with local laws and regulations.

Responsibilities

Associates, Home Managers, and Business Managers have responsibility for ensuring an effective and meaningful performance management process. Specially:

Associates

- Regularly check Cognizant communication channels (including email) about upcoming Performance Management tasks and deadlines.
- Partner with their Home Manager and/or Business Manager to set goals during the goal-setting window.
- Proactively seek and discuss training and development opportunities with their Home Manager.
- Proactively discuss career goals and aspirations with their Home Manager.
- Complete self-assessment.
- Seek feedback from their Home Manager, Business Manager, and key stakeholders throughout the performance year.
- Actively participate in the process, be open to feedback, ask questions to ensure understanding.
- Be receptive to change and make an intentional effort to address areas for improvement.

Home Managers and Business Managers

- Understand that performance management is an essential and critical job function for all people management roles.
- Treat all team members, direct reports and business reports equitably, fairly, and with respect.

- Collaborate with the Associate's Business Manager/Home Manager throughout the Performance Management process.
- Help Associates define their individual goals in alignment with the project/account goals and the broader organization goals.
- Prioritize and invest time and resources to participate actively in the Associate's overall performance and career development.
- Measure and assess based on the Associates' outcomes/performance.
- Provide overall project feedback within two weeks of an Associate's assignment on the project/account ending.
- Consolidate, deliver and document real-time, objective feedback.
- Take ownership of final ratings.
- Create an environment where Associates feel empowered to initiate conversations about their performance.
- Regularly check Cognizant communication channels (including email) about upcoming Performance Management tasks and deadlines.
- Complete steps in the process in a timely manner.
- Refer to [Business Manager Roles](#) document on Be.Cognizant for further details for the responsibilities for each role.

Policy modifications

Cognizant reserves the right to amend its policies as necessary. Any changes to the Global Performance Management Policy will be approved by the Chief People Officer.

This policy is subject to the consultation with and approval of local works councils, where applicable.

Version history

Revision Date	Description of Change
NOV-24-2021	Initial Release
MAY-19-2023	Transitioned to new template
AUG-11-2025	Updated Links
APR-27-2026	MyPerformance link replaced with LPM link under Related Policies & Processes.

Policy control information

Policy Name: Global Performance Management Policy

Department: Human Resources

Effective Date: NOV-24-2021

Revision Date: APR-27-2026

Policy Owner: Chief People Officer